

# UAP Disclosure Investigation — April 29, 2026

## Update

Continues from [Architecture Mapping Handoff](#) (April 28, 2026).

### Investigation

This investigation maps the U.S. defense apparatus that determines what reaches public view about Unidentified Anomalous Phenomena: the Office of the Under Secretary of War for Intelligence and Security (OUSW(I&S), formerly OUSD(I&S) before EO 14347), the Influence and Perception Management Office (IPMO, established March 2022), the All-domain Anomaly Resolution Office (AARO, established July 2022), and the contractor substrate around them.

The thesis: AARO is not the truth-seeking office it presents as. It operates inside an institutional structure whose incentives are perception management, not disclosure. The central documented evidence is OUSD(I&S)'s November 2023 line-by-line rewrite of the Schumer-Rounds UAP Disclosure Act, which gutted the bill's independent Review Board, "outside the Federal Government" contractor-records protection, supremacy clause, eminent domain authority, and Attorney General subpoena power before it became FY24 NDAA Subtitle C (Public Law 118-31). The architecture's preferred end-state — AARO-mediated, executive-branch-controlled selective reveal under FY24 Subtitle C — is the operative law, and it has now survived two administrations, two USD(I&S)/USW(I&S) personnel changes, the DoD→DoW rebrand under EO 14347, an AARO Director succession (Kirkpatrick → Phillips → Kosloski), an FY26 OP-5 budget-line rename to "Advanced Intelligence Capabilities," and the FY26 NDAA cycle without revision.

The architecture is layered: governance authority (OUSW(I&S), IPMO), operational programs (DMDPO and other MILDEC infrastructure under SM&OIE), public-facing instrument (AARO), and contractor substrate (Sancorp, the Battelle/UT-Battelle ecosystem). Personnel cycle through it. Moultrie (USD(I&S) June 2021 – February 29, 2024) sat on Battelle's Advisory Board pre-government, July 2016 – April 2018. Kirkpatrick (AARO Director until December 2023) joined Oak Ridge National Laboratory — operated by Battelle subsidiary UT-Battelle — as CTO of Defense and Intelligence Programs immediately after. AARO sent its 2024 Ohio metallic-sample analysis to ORNL during Moultrie's tenure. The "Gerb" UAP whistleblower (IBTimes UK, January 2026) labeled this the "Battelle job carousel" and a "closed loop of power"; both empirical legs now stand on primary-source evidence.

This session covered five threads: Battelle 990s and the Moultrie-Battelle relationship; AARO publication cadence; IPMO leadership succession; FY26 NDAA UAP provisions; Sancorp post-GAO diversification.

## Findings

**Moultrie — Battelle Advisory Board.** Ronald Moultrie served as Advisory Board Member at Battelle Memorial Institute, July 2016 – April 2018, per his contemporaneous LinkedIn profile (<https://www.linkedin.com/in/ronald-ron-moultrie-849b76112/>) printed June 27, 2018 and shared by Christopher Sharp on Twitter/X (<https://twitter.com/ChrisUKSharp>). Battelle Form 990 filings for FY ending Sept 30, 2019 (<https://www.battelle.org/docs/default-source/privacy-policies-disclosures/2018-990-990t.pdf>) and FY ending Sept 30, 2021 (<https://www.battelle.org/docs/default-source/privacy-policies-disclosures/bmi-2020-990-and-990t—fy21.pdf>) confirm he was not on the Board of Directors during those years; Form 990 Part VII Section A does not require listing Advisory Board members (<https://www.irs.gov/instructions/i990>). Battelle is absent from all current public Moultrie biographies (HASC March 2022, war.gov, INSA, LeoLabs, Wikipedia, Grokipedia), but the same omission applies to all 2015–2018 advisory roles.

**AARO publication blackout.** AARO has produced no new annual report, congressional briefing, transcript, or press release between November 14, 2024 and April 29, 2026 — approximately 17.5 months (<https://www.aaro.mil/Congressional-Press-Products/>). The only entry added in that window is a single February 27, 2026 link to a war.gov omnibus piece, which is not an AARO product. FY25 Annual Report and HRR Volume II both remain overdue.

**AARO branding persists despite AIC budget rename.** The FY26 OSD OP-5 budget document renames the AARO budget line to “Advanced Intelligence Capabilities (AIC)” while preserving AARO’s exact charter mandate language. Direct fetch of [aaro.mil](https://aaro.mil) confirms the public surface — URL, seal, page titles, navigation, and the 2025-dated mission brief and declassification information paper — all continue to use the AARO name. Future analysts searching FY26+ OSD OP-5 documents for “AARO” will not find this line item.

**Holly upgraded from Acting to Director of IPMO.** James Holly was billed as “Acting Director” through October 2023 and as “Director” by July 23, 2024 (Information Professionals Association keynote, <https://information-professionals.org/event/save-the-date-ipa-members-only-evening-social-23-july-2024/>). Defense One’s May 24, 2024 piece is the earliest reference dropping the “Acting” qualifier (<https://www.defenseone.com/technology/2024/05/losing-hearts-and-minds-desperate-state-us-influence-operations/396889/>). IPMO leadership continuity across the Biden→Trump transition and the OUSD(I&S)→OUSW(I&S) EO 14347 rebrand.

**FY26 NDAA enacted as P.L. 119-60.** Signed December 18, 2025

(<https://www.whitehouse.gov/briefings-statements/2025/12/congressional-bill-s-1071-signed-into-law/>). Three incremental AARO-directed UAP provisions made it in: NORAD/NORTHCOM intercept briefings going back to 2004; AARO classification matrix accountability with an explicit 2026 annual report mandate; federal UAP data routing streamlining (<https://defensescoop.com/2025/12/10/uap-ufo-military-intercepts-north-america-fy-2026-ndaa/>, <https://www.meritalk.com/articles/pentagon-uap-briefings-added-in-ndaa/>). The 2024 reintroduced UAPDA (SA 2610) and its Section II15 explicit repeal of FY24 NDAA Subtitle C did not advance; FY24 NDAA Subtitle C remains operative law.

**Sancorp post-GAO diversification.** The July 2025 USSOUTHCOM Support to Special Technical Operations contract (<https://www.sancorpconsulting.com/items-1/sancorp-july-2025>) explicitly includes “MILITARY DECEPTION (MILDEC)” in PWS scope (<https://www.govconinbox.com/explore/contractors/profile/GRYKNJ8BGFC8>). Sancorp also awarded the Missile Defense Agency SHIELD IDIQ with \$151B aggregate ceiling (<https://www.sancorpconsulting.com/>) — order-of-magnitude departure from the OUSW(I&S) ecosystem, aligned with Trump’s Golden Dome priority. Pre-cliff diversification ahead of August 26, 2027 8(a) expiry.

## Repo updates

| Item                                                      | Status                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Moultrie on Battelle Advisory Board (Jul 2016 – Apr 2018) | ✅ Confirmed                                                                   |
| Moultrie on Battelle Board of Directors (FY 9/19, 9/21)   | ❌ Ruled out via 990s                                                          |
| Battelle “job carousel” — both legs                       | ✅ Confirmed (Kirkpatrick → ORNL Dec 2023; Moultrie → Battelle Advisory Board) |
| “Removed from official biography” Battelle claim          | ⚠️ Factually accurate; pattern applies to all 2015–2018 advisory roles        |
| AARO publication blackout (~17.5 months)                  | ✅ Confirmed                                                                   |
| AARO branding persists despite AIC budget rename          | ✅ Confirmed                                                                   |
| Holly upgraded from Acting to Director of IPMO            | ✅ Confirmed                                                                   |
| FY26 NDAA enacted P.L. 119-60; three                      |                                                                               |

|                                                    |             |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| incremental UAP provisions                         | ✓ Confirmed |
| 2024 UAPDA (SA 2610) did not advance in FY26 cycle | ✓ Confirmed |
| Sancorp USSOUTHCOM STO with MILDEC scope           | ✓ Confirmed |
| Sancorp MDA SHIELD IDIQ (\$151B ceiling)           | ✓ Confirmed |

## Open items

1. Moultrie's entry-level OGE Form 278 (filed June 2021) — Schedule D/E/F entries for Battelle; recusal or screening agreement re: Battelle, UT-Battelle, ORNL.  
<https://www.oge.gov/>
2. Kirkpatrick's OGE Form 278 for AARO Director tenure (July 2022 – December 2023).  
<https://www.oge.gov/>
3. OUSW(I&S) "informal views" rewrite of 2024 UAPDA submitted for FY25 or FY26 NDAA cycles (FOIA via OUSW(I&S) Office of Legislative Affairs).
4. The 91 withheld pages of FOIA 23-F-0905 (MDR appeal).
5. Identity of Sancorp employee "X" from GAO B-422985 (resigned February 7, 2025).
6. Specific Battelle advisory body Moultrie sat on. LinkedIn entry says only "Advisory Board"; Battelle does not publish advisory-body membership; direct corporate inquiry required.
7. Battelle Advisory Board compensation structure, 2016–2018 (Battelle 990 Schedule J or Moultrie OGE Form 278).
8. Timing of 2024 ORNL metallic-sample analysis relative to Moultrie's February 29, 2024 USD(I&S) departure.
9. Christopher Sharp's specific tweet ID containing the LinkedIn screenshot (timeline review of @ChrisUKSharp).
10. Formal DoD announcement of Holly's transition from Acting Director to Director of IPMO (October 2023 – May 2024 window).
11. Dollar values on Sancorp's USSOUTHCOM STO and OASD(S&T) awards (USAspending.gov).

12. AARO HRR Volume II and FY25 Annual Report substantive content (when released).
13. Embedded personnel cohort identification (LinkedIn cross-referencing).
14. Battelle 990s for FY ending Sept 30, 2020 (gap-fill) and pre-2018 series (closeout).  
Index: <https://www.battelle.org/site/disclosures>